

TAGLIATELLE WITH MATSUTAKE MUSHROOMS, LEMON, AND MINT

SERVES
4-6

TOTAL TIME
1 h 15 min plus the dough rest

INGREDIENTS

1 batch	Egg dough
454 g	Matsutake mushrooms
168 g	Olive oil, for the mushrooms
14 g	Olive oil, for the garlic
25 g	Garlic, finely chopped
60 g	Unsalted butter, cold and cubed
45 g	Parmigiano-reggiano, finely grated
1	Lemon, peel finely chopped and pith removed
20 g	Parsley, finely chopped
30	Mint leaves
quantity not given	Black pepper

METHOD

1. Cut 624 g of tagliatelle from the egg dough.
2. Clean the mushrooms by paring the first layer of flesh off the stems with a paring knife, taking as little as you can. Wipe the rest of the dirt away with a slightly damp towel, gently but thoroughly.
3. Slice the mushrooms very thinly, cutting through caps and stems alike, to pieces around 1/8 inch thick and 2 inches long.
4. Set a large saute pan over high heat with 56 g of the olive oil. Lay a third of the mushrooms into the pan in an even layer and sear them 5 to 7 minutes, turning them so the color goes on evenly, until the edges are golden brown and they are cooked through. They will still feel firm because matsutakes are so meaty, but they take on a gloss. Move them to a plate or bowl.
5. Repeat twice more, 56 g of oil to each batch, until all the mushrooms are done. Keep the pan.
6. Salt a large pot of water heavily and bring it to the boil.
7. While it heats, put the pan back over low heat with the last 14 g of oil. Give the garlic 10 to 15 seconds, until aromatic but without color, then return all the mushrooms and stir them through.
8. Cook the tagliatelle 30 seconds to 1 minute. It wants to be tender, not soft.
9. While it cooks, add 2 to 3 ladles of pasta water, 115 g to 170 g, and the butter to the mushroom pan, and swirl to emulsify.
10. Lift the pasta over with tongs or a pasta basket, raise the heat to medium and toss 1 to 2 minutes to marry.
11. Off the heat, add half the parmigiano, then the lemon peel and parsley, tossing as you go. A splash of pasta water loosens the sauce if it tightens. It is ready when it clings with a gloss.
12. Divide into bowls and finish with the remaining parmigiano, the mint leaves and pepper.

NOTES

Matsutake season is short, September through November, and they are hard to find even inside it. Porcini or king oyster, also sold as trumpet royale, both substitute. Their flavor differs but both are meaty enough that the texture of the dish survives. Sear the mushrooms in three batches with fresh oil each time. A crowded pan steams them instead of coloring them. Matsutakes stay firm when they are cooked through. Judge them by the gloss, not by softness. Mint stands in for nepitella, a perennial herb whose aroma sits between mint and marjoram.

SHAPE

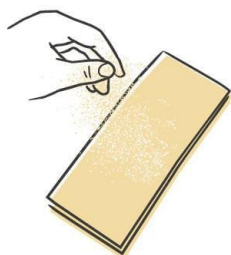
Tagliatelle

Region: Emilia-Romagna and neighboring regions. Called fettuccine in Lazio / Rest: 20-30 min at room temperature

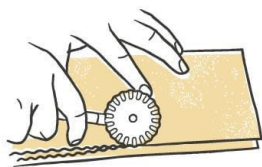
METHOD

1. Make an egg-based dough, then roll and sheet it.
2. Give a wooden work surface a light dusting of 00 flour. Line a sheet pan with parchment, then dust the parchment with semolina.
3. Knife the sheets into 12-inch lengths and trim the ragged edges off. Save the trim for soup.
4. Dust each sheet lightly with 00 flour and stack them neatly two or three high. Run a fluted pastry cutter around every edge of the stack so all the edges come out ruffled.
5. Starting at the long edge of the stack, cut 1/2-inch strands working inward. A ruler or straightedge keeps the lines even while you get used to the fluted cutter.
6. Dust the strands generously with 00 flour and shake them apart. Bend the batch into a horseshoe and set it on the pan.
7. Repeat with the rest of the sheets.
8. Dry 20 to 30 minutes at room temperature.
9. To hold, cover the pan with plastic and refrigerate up to 24 hours.

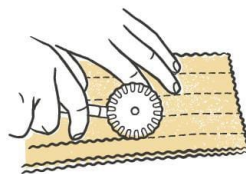
SHAPING



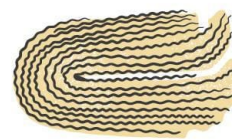
1



2



3



4



5



6

NOTES

Cut width is 1/2 inch, with a fluted pastry cutter.

Bologna's Accademia Italiana della Cucina specifies 1/3 inch. Robbins goes wider on purpose, because her tagliatelle and her fettuccine are rolled to the same thinness and the width is what separates them. Widths vary across the region anyway.

The fluted cutter is Robbins' own distinction for this shape, not a traditional requirement.

Sheets are 12 inches long, stacked two or three high to cut.

Shaped into a horseshoe rather than a nest.

Refrigerated shelf life is 24 hours.

Suits a hearty ragu, or light butter-and-cheese sauces carrying seasonal vegetables such as mushrooms or zucchini.

DOUGH

Egg Dough

Makes: 954 g / Active Time: 8-10 min kneading / Rest: 30 min minimum, wrapped

INGREDIENTS

500 g	Tipo 00 flour
454 g	Egg yolks
as needed	Extra 00 flour for kneading
up to 1 tbsp, only if dry	Room-temperature water

METHOD

1. Mix the yolks lightly, without beating them.
2. Mound the flour on a wooden surface and open a well 5 to 6 inches across. Wider than that and the walls collapse.
3. Add half the yolks, drawing in flour from the inner wall with a fork, working round the circumference.
4. Add the rest the same way. If the wall breaks, scrape the escape back into the flour until the mass holds itself.
5. Knead 8 to 10 minutes: press down and away with the heel of your hand, rotate 180 degrees, fold, repeat. Scrape your hands and the board as you go.
6. Add water a tablespoon at a time only if it stays dry and refuses to come together.
7. Stop when it is smooth, firm, and springs back slightly when poked. The texture to aim for is Play-Doh.
8. Wrap and rest at least 30 minutes before rolling.

NOTES

454 g of yolks is roughly 24 to 26 eggs, so plan what the whites are for.

Yolks only, no whites and no whole eggs, which is what makes this rich and tender rather than elastic.

Dry winter air is the usual reason it will not come together. Flour the board sparingly, since excess dries it out.

Keeps 24 hours. Chilled overnight, pull it out 20 minutes before rolling.